PDF forms are not compatible with the Google Chrome PDF viewer plug-in. Chrome users should save the form, then reopen and complete with Adobe reader.

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

I decided to research the decrease of water level of the Dead Sea. It’s one of my favorite places and I'm passionate about protecting natural environments damaged by humans. Since it's a multifaceted issue it was difficult for me to choose a specific topic but I decided to investigate how sustainable is the withdrawal of water from the Dead Sea. My extended essay was secondary research based therefore I have learned about the advantage and disadvantages of secondary data. It allowed me to access higher level of information that I wouldn't be able to collect myself due to for example a lack of equipment. It also allows access to a wider data range with no geographical limitations which helps to draw a logical conclusion and enables me to investigate a place I'm passionate about. However sometimes finding specific data from my research was really difficult as maybe no one has measured or published it before.
While researching I had difficulties finding relevant reliable data since most sources don't share information easily, which I found frustrating. I decided to directly contact them and I was happy to find sources from different perspectives (Israel, Jordanian, International, etc.) and that I have the advantage of understanding sources in Hebrew. I felt disappointed since there are many stakeholders regarding this situation, yet, nobody takes action or tries to mitigate the human effects
Overall I felt like the results of this research showed that the Dead Sea is in an unsustainable negative situation. I was surprised to find out that the domestic sector has a significant influence on it. I think that if my research were to be published, I would not change much. The study shows a significant decrease in water level but since money and politics are involved the government does not impose new regulations which I find frustrating. While writing the essay I had difficulty with finding particular maps in English and eventually I found out one which shows the general pattern but isn't up to date. For me the most difficult thing was finding reliable data. Overall, I think that I learned a lot and I am better prepare if I have to write another research paper.

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